

Project Timeline, Proposals and Ethics

COMP3050: Individual Dissertation (2025-2026)

Matthew Pike

Welcome back!

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- Office Hours: Mondays: 13:00 - 14:00;
Tuesdays: 16:00 - 17:00



Figure 1: Please call me “Matt”.

- **Title:** Projects in Computing and Information Systems
- **Edition:** Third
- **Author:** Christian W. Dawson
- **Publisher:** Pearson
- **ISBN:** 978-1-292-07346-0
- **Available at:** University Library, Online Resources

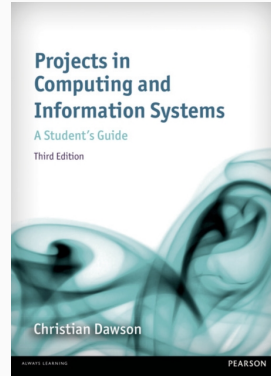


Figure 2: Projects in Computing and Information Systems - Book Cover

Housekeeping



Reminder

If you haven't already, confirm your supervision arrangements as soon as possible.

- The deadline for project allocation is **08 Oct 2025 @ 15:00**.
 - If you haven't confirmed your FYP supervision arrangements, please do so immediately as you are behind schedule.
 - If you've agreed with a supervisor but they haven't informed the module convenor yet, remind them to do so as soon as possible.
 - Your supervision is only confirmed once you receive an email from the module convenor confirming your project allocation.

A Reminder: BCS and MoE Requirements

- The British Computer Society (BCS) accredits our degree programmes.
 - This accreditation confirms that our programmes meet BCS standards.
 - It serves as important external recognition of the quality of our degrees.
- Similarly, the Chinese Ministry of Education (MoE) has requirements that graduating students must meet to receive MoE recognition upon graduation.
- These requirements may impact whether you complete the FYP module, depending on your individual circumstances.

Requires Action!

Arrange regular supervision meetings with your supervisor.

- Suggested that you meet your supervisor weekly (30 mins) or fortnightly (1 hour).
- It's your responsibility to organise these meetings.
- Use meetings to discuss progress and get feedback.
- Lead the meetings by sending an agenda in advance.
- We'll soon cover how to effectively “manage” your supervisor.

- Autumn semester lectures are timetabled for **Monday's 11:00 - 12:00** in **DB-C05+**.
- We won't meet every week—lectures will be announced in advance.
 - No announcement means no lecture.
- Recordings and slides will be available on Moodle.
- Attendance is recorded automatically.
- The provisional lecture schedule is on Moodle, with two main facilitators:
 - Module Convener: FYP logistics and deliverables.
 - Writing Lab: Academic writing, time management, etc.



Giving Feedback

Your feedback helps improve the module, so please share your thoughts!

- **Giving Feedback**

- You can submit feedback anytime via the MS Form (link on Moodle).
- Feedback is processed anonymous, but your name and email will be recorded.
- All feedback is reviewed and responded to by the module convenor, with responses shared on Moodle.

- **Receiving Feedback**

- For assessments, your supervisor will provide feedback, either written, verbal, or both.
- If you don't receive feedback, contact your supervisor.

Provisional Deliverable Deadlines

Deliverable	Contribution	Due Date
Project Allocation Confirmation	Mandatory	08 Oct 2025 @ 15:00
Submit Project Proposal	2%	28 Oct 2025 @ 15:00
Preliminary Ethics Form	Mandatory	28 Oct 2025 @ 15:00
Full Ethics Form	If required	18 Nov 2025 @ 15:00
Interim Report	8%	16 Dec 2025 @ 15:00
Dissertation	75%	28 Apr 2026 @ 15:00
Demonstration	10%	05 May 2026 @ 15:00
Q&A Session	5%	14 May 2026 @ 11:00 - 13:00

Table 1: Project Deliverables and Deadlines

Project Proposal

Tip: Figure Out Your Typesetting System Now

It's a good idea to choose your typesetting system now, while your workload is lighter. $\text{\LaTeX}$ is recommended, but you're free to use any system you prefer.

- Project proposals are assessed and contribute 2% of your overall FYP mark.
- It is recommended that proposals be 2,000 words (around 4 pages, excluding the cover page).
- Proposals are a strong indicator of future performance.
- They will be evaluated using the rubric available on Moodle.
- Ensure you fully understand the rubric.
- Review your proposal against the rubric before final submission.

Project Proposal: What to Include

- **Cover page (1 page):**
 - Include the project title, your name, ID, email, supervisor's name, and your programme of study (e.g. CS or CSAI).
- **Background and motivation (1 page):**
 - Briefly outline the background of the project, the importance of the area, and your motivation for undertaking the work.
- **Aim(s) and objectives (0.5 page):**
 - The aim is a single sentence summarising the project's purpose and what will be achieved.
 - The objectives outline the key tasks needed to achieve the aim.
- **Work plan (1 page):**
 - Describe the tasks to be completed.
 - Ensure the time plan is realistic, accounting for other commitments like exams and holidays.
 - It's recommended to include a suitable chart (e.g. Gantt chart).
- **Bibliography (0.5 page):**
 - Provide a selection of key works in your field.

Project Proposal: Assessment Criteria

- **Aim(s) and objectives:**
 - The aim is a single sentence describing the project's overall purpose and what will be achieved.
 - The objectives outline the key tasks needed to meet the aim.
- **Focus and Motivation:**
 - Relevant key works are identified and briefly discussed to provide context.
 - The project's importance is clearly stated.
- **Work schedule/plan:**
 - A clear, realistic, and well-structured plan is provided.
- **References:**
 - Key works are presented in a consistent and appropriate format.
- **Technical writing skills and document presentation** are also assessed.

Pair Activity: Project Proposal Rubric (~10 mins)

i Consider: Why are you doing this?

This activity helps you understand the marking rubric, which will be used to assess all proposals. Use the rubric to guide your writing.

- Form pairs or groups of three.
- On one device, open the project proposal rubric.
 - The rubric is available on Moodle under the “Project Proposal” section.
- On another device, open an example project proposal.
- Review the rubric and apply it to the selected proposal.
 - Discuss each criterion and agree on a mark for each.

Ethical Considerations, Requirements and Approval

What is Ethics?

! Important Warning

- Failure to obtain ethics approval is considered research misconduct.
- Some UoN students have been unable to graduate for not obtaining ethics approval.
- Be aware that random ethics checks will be conducted annually by the faculty.

- Research ethics addresses moral issues that may arise during research.
- The university is responsible for ensuring research is conducted ethically and takes this very seriously.

“UNNC requires the highest standards of integrity to be followed in the pursuit of research carried out by the academic and research staff, and students of the University.”

- For more details, refer to the UNNC Research Ethics Policy and Procedures:
 - <https://www.nottingham.edu.cn/en/research/researchethics/ethics-approval-process.aspx>

1. All Projects

- Must submit the Preliminary UG & PGT Research Ethics Checklist.
 - If you answered “yes” to any questions, complete the “Full” UG & PGT Research Ethics Checklist.
 - If you answered “no” to all questions, obtained your supervisor’s signature, and submitted the form on Moodle, no further checklist is required.

2. Projects with Identified Risks

- Must complete the “Full” UG & PGT Research Ethics Checklist and obtain full ethics clearance before starting the study.

3. Ongoing Monitoring of Ethical Implications

- **Stay aware of any changes to your project** that may affect its ethical implications.
- If the project changes, you may need to submit a new ethics application. Consult your supervisor if unsure.



Upkeep of Ethics Status

Important: It is your responsibility to manage the ethical status of your project, not your supervisor's. You should, of course, regularly engage with your supervisor to discuss the ethical status of your project as it evolves.

- **Hypothetical Case 1: Project Scope Change**

- Initially, the ethics checklist was correct with no human participants.
- Later, the project scope changed to involve human participants, but the student failed to update the ethics documentation.

- **Hypothetical Case 2: Data from Friends**

- The student intended to collect data from friends but did not tick “Involves human participants” on the ethics checklist.



Be Proactive with your Ethics Approval

Start discussing the ethical implications of your project with your supervisor.

- If your project involves human participants, you must complete the “full” ethics approval procedure.
- Projects involving health-related aspects (e.g., medical data, devices) require the “full” ethics approval procedure and review by the Faculty Ethics Sub-Committee.
- It’s better to be safe than sorry. If unsure, complete the “full” procedure, but always consult your supervisor first.

Questions?
